

Report conversation

when asking if a user is enjoying your app, is it common practice to open up a review window if they say yes

Yes, this is a common practice among app developers, and it's often referred to as "review gating". When a user indicates that they're enjoying the app, the developer might prompt them to leave a positive review on the app store. This tactic can help an app accumulate more positive reviews, which can lead to better visibility in app store rankings.

However, both Apple and Google have policies against this practice as they aim to get unbiased reviews from users. Specifically, Apple's App Store Review Guidelines state: "Don't directly or indirectly discourage users from making negative reports or reviews" (as of my knowledge cutoff in September 2021).

This means that apps shouldn't only direct happy users to the app store to leave reviews, but should give all users the same opportunity. If a developer uses review gating and Apple finds out, the app could be rejected or removed from the App Store.

Google Play Store has similar policies.

So while it may be tempting to try to boost your positive reviews this way, it's important to follow the guidelines and rules set by the app stores to avoid potential issues. It's always a good idea to encourage users to leave feedback, but it should be done in a fair and unbiased way.

Do i need to give them a second prompt asking if they would like to review the app or should i just avoid the click and open the review

The exact implementation can vary, but a generally accepted best practice is to provide a secondary prompt. If a user has indicated that they're enjoying the app, you can then ask

if they'd be willing to leave a review. This respects the user's time and gives them the chance to decline if they prefer not to leave a review. It also ensures you're not taking them out of their current app experience without their explicit consent, which could otherwise be disruptive or frustrating.

Here's a rough example of how this might look:

1. User action triggers a prompt: "Are you enjoying our app?"
2. If the user responds positively (e.g., by clicking "Yes"), you show a second prompt: "Would you like to leave a review?"
3. If the user agrees, then you can direct them to the app store to leave a review.

Again, keep in mind that your practices should adhere to the guidelines of the platform your app is on. Both the Apple App Store and Google Play Store have rules about how you can solicit reviews from users. Always make sure to stay updated on these rules to avoid any potential issues.

Is there evidence to suggest that not including step 2 would be harmful

As of my knowledge cutoff in September 2021, there isn't any specific research or evidence indicating that skipping the second prompt would be directly harmful. However, general user experience (UX) principles and practices can provide some guidance.

1. **Respect for the user's time and control:** By giving users the option to leave a review, rather than taking them directly to a review page, you're respecting their time and maintaining their control over their experience. If users are suddenly taken out of their app experience to leave a review without their explicit consent, they might feel annoyed or interrupted, which could negatively impact their overall perception of your app.
2. **Informed decisions:** The second prompt gives users a chance to make an informed decision about whether they want to take the time to leave a review. Without it, they may feel pushed into doing something they didn't plan on, which can lead to a negative experience.

- 3. Risk of negative reviews:** If users feel forced or tricked into leaving a review, they might not only decline but also react negatively, potentially leading to negative reviews.
- 4. Compliance with app store guidelines:** As previously mentioned, app store guidelines require you to be upfront and honest with your users when soliciting reviews. Skipping the second prompt might violate these guidelines.

While it's difficult to quantify exactly how much harm could come from not including a second prompt, these factors suggest it's a good idea to include one. It provides a more respectful and positive user experience, which in the long run is likely to result in more positive reviews and user satisfaction.